Attitudes of Filipino Millennials Towards Purchase and Consumption of Luxury Brands: Actual and Ideal Self-Congruity on Brand Attitude

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Abstract

This study set out to uncover what drives the attitudes of Filipino millennials when it comes to buying and using luxury brands. A wide body of research from other countries, spanning different demographics and cultural settings, has already given useful insight into how buyers elsewhere view luxury purchasing and use. Here, though, the central focus is on how Filipino millennials' own sense of actual versus ideal self-congruity shapes their attitude toward luxury — in other words, pinpointing exactly what pushes or pulls Filipino millennials toward buying and using these brands.

The study also brought in materialistic value and status value as additional angles, examining how much weight these carry in shaping consumer motivation. Both the research questions and the hypotheses were tackled and answered using a quantitative approach. A structured survey questionnaire was handed out to university students, recent graduates, and young professionals across a range of organizations, all falling under the millennial bracket. The findings revealed that ideal self-congruity carries noticeably more weight than actual self-congruity in shaping how Filipino millennial consumers feel about luxury brands. This influence came through clearly in how respondents valued materialism and prestige.

What this study contributes should be useful on both the business and academic side. Since Filipino millennials make up roughly a third of the country's population and about half its labor force, the results offer a solid, evidence-based starting point for understanding their brand attitudes — a topic that hadn't been examined in much depth within the Philippine context before. The findings should also be of practical use to luxury brand managers looking for direction on the right marketing mix and strategy when targeting this generation of consumers.

Keywords: consumer attitude, luxury brand, Filipino millennials, actual & ideal self-congruity, purchase and consumption, motivational factors

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Introduction

Bain's tracking of the luxury industry covers both luxury goods and luxury experiences, spanning nine segments in total. Of these, luxury cars, luxury hospitality, and personal luxury goods together make up more than 80% of the overall market. In 2018 the global luxury market grew by 5%, reaching an estimated €1.2 trillion, with most segments posting gains. Luxury car sales remained the market's biggest driver, climbing 5% at constant exchange rates to €495 billion. Experience-based luxury also held strong appeal, with hospitality sales up 5%, gourmet food and fine dining up 6%, and luxury cruises up 7%. Online sales climbed to an 8% market share, while discounted sales made up as much as 37% of total sales (D'Arpizio et al., 2016). Meanwhile, younger buyers — Generation Y, or millennials, born in the 1980s and 1990s — have been developing an appetite for luxury goods earlier in life than traditional luxury shoppers ever did, and their share of luxury purchases has grown substantially (The Economist, 2014).

These younger buyers also behave very differently at the point of purchase: more impulsive, more willing to experiment, and more inclined to try new brands, in contrast to older luxury consumers who tend to spend consistently and stay loyal to established brands (Jay, 2012). Projections suggest millennials will become the dominant luxury buyers by 2026, meaning brand managers will need to rework their marketing and brand strategies to capture this large, fast-growing segment and stay ahead of competitors (The Economist, 2014).

Brand plays a central role in how consumers make decisions, yet research into what actually drives luxury consumption and how luxury brands should be managed remains fairly thin. In particular, the link between how consumers perceive luxury and what actually pushes them to buy luxury brands is still not well understood or explored (Hennigs et al., 2013) — and the Philippines is a clear example of this gap. Luxury brands meet both psychological and functional needs through a blend of four value dimensions: financial, operational, individual, and social (Wiedmann et al., 2007). These four dimensions allow customers to be grouped as either personally-oriented or socially-oriented — essentially, whether someone buys luxury for personal enjoyment or to show off success (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009). This means luxury brands have to deliver value that matches each customer's own expectations and perceptions (Hennigs et al., 2013).

Millennials themselves have become a popular research subject, largely because they puzzle older generations. They are deeply connected socially, and heavily reliant on social media and digital tools.

Roughly a third of Filipinos fall into the millennial bracket, aged 15 to 35. While millennials broadly share certain values and identities, these come in different layers, meaning there isn't just one type of millennial — it depends on how they want to present themselves to the world. Given this, brands need to engage millennials more directly to build marketability and affiliation with them. Millennials, more than previous generations, place their trust in shared experience rather than in authority alone (http://pana.com.ph/decoding-millennials/).

Literature Review

The word "luxury" gets used constantly, yet no single, fixed definition of it exists — what counts as luxury for one person may not for another (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014). Still, certain traits are commonly used to define it: excellent quality, high price, scarcity and uniqueness, aesthetics and polysensuality, ancestral heritage and personal history, and superfluousness (Dubois et al., 2001).

Luxury isn't the same thing as fashion or as "premium," even though the concepts overlap and borrow from one another (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014). Simply having one of the traits above — high price, for instance — isn't enough on its own to qualify something as luxury, which is why upper-range premium products are often mistaken for luxury goods. For premium products, price tracks functionality, performance, and quality; for true luxury, price tracks scarcity, brand, and storytelling instead (Turunen, 2015). At the same time, many luxury brands borrow behaviors from fashion brands, just as fashion brands try to associate themselves with luxury to boost their own status (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

Luxury goods are also tied to the idea of a dream, whereas essential goods answer a need, and branded goods in between answer a passing desire and can usually be substituted. Dreams go beyond need or want, and it's this dream-like quality that luxury goods respond to and that sets them apart from non-luxury goods (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014). Buying a luxury item is really buying into that dream, and such purchases tend to be impulsive, emotional, or extravagant (Dubois & Paternault, 1995). This is part of why the luxury industry runs on unusually high profitability and margins — strong brand equity and reputation add extra value to already expensive, high-quality products (Kapferer, 1997).

Luxury brands can also be sorted by how accessible they are — available, intermediate, or inaccessible (De Barnier et al., 2011). Other classification schemes drawn from earlier literature (Vigneron & Johnson, 1999; Kapferer, 2008; Corbellini & Saviolo, 2009) are summarized elsewhere (Turunen, 2015). One reason luxury has become harder to define cleanly is that brands keep extending into new categories; when a luxury brand launches a cheaper line-extension — a perfume, say — it gives consumers a taste of the brand at a more accessible price point (Patrick & Prokopec, 2015). Understanding what motivates luxury purchases really comes down to understanding what value the product holds for the person using it (Ballantyne & Varey, 2006). People consume differently, and the personal and social behaviors behind luxury consumption vary from one consumer to the next (Holt, 1995). Consumers look to build a meaningful life around their identity and relationships, so that what they consume adds to their quality of life through the enjoyment that comes from owning and using products and experiences (Pollay, 1983; Solomon et al., 2016). How a consumer perceives a luxury brand therefore shapes how relevant that consumption feels to them; understanding a person's broader consumption values helps explain how they individualize their views on luxury and how luxury brands end up shaping their daily lives (Seo & Buchanan-Oliver, 2014).

Kapferer and Bastien (2014) split luxury consumers into heavy users and occasional users. Up until around 2000, the luxury market grew mainly because large numbers of middle-class shoppers bought luxury items now and then. Today, though, the bulk of luxury purchases comes from frequent buyers. Western middle classes, worried about their financial futures, increasingly feel poorer and are drifting toward less affluent spending categories, while wealthier buyers have stayed optimistic and now account for most of the luxury market. This split has let luxury brands grow their entry-level, "masstige" product lines aimed at middle-class shoppers who still aspire to luxury but spend more cautiously. Young Chinese middle-class consumers show the opposite pattern — despite having less money overall, their income keeps rising, leaving them feeling optimistic and prosperous, which has made China's luxury market

especially dynamic. A similar dynamic may help explain the rising number of Gen-Y luxury buyers, particularly since the 2008 recession, as this generation increasingly turns to luxury consumption as a form of self-indulgence (Jay, 2012).

Kapferer's 1998 research on an international sample of affluent young consumers identified four distinct types of luxury buyers, based on what luxury means to them and which qualities they value most. The first group values the beauty, excellence, and uniqueness of the product itself. The second cares most about creativity and sensuality. The third bases luxury value on timelessness and international reputation — luxury as a "safe" choice. The fourth group focuses on rarity and the most exclusive, hard-to-get products, and tends to buy the priciest items available. Interestingly, this fourth group skewed mostly male, while the second skewed mostly female — suggesting that men lean toward visible signs of success, while women place more weight on creativity, sensuality, and beauty. Young men, in this sense, consume luxury mainly to display their progress. The third group, meanwhile, responds to active, visible signals and well-known brand names, while the second group is more focused on individuality, and the first sees itself as connoisseurs capable of appreciating truly exceptional products.

Han et al. (2010) offer another way of segmenting luxury consumers, this time based on how much a consumer relies on brand prominence — that is, how visible the logo is — to signal status. The stronger someone's need for status, the more they lean on "loud" signals like conspicuous logos. Those with less need for status tend to do the opposite. Wealthy consumers with a lower need for status prefer quiet signals — premium products without an obvious logo, recognizable mainly to others within the same social circle. Wealthy consumers who do need status, on the other hand, use loud luxury products specifically to distinguish themselves from those less well-off, while less affluent consumers with a high need for status often turn to counterfeit luxury goods to mimic higher social standing since they can't afford the real thing. This dynamic shows how consumers are shaped by the groups they aspire to belong to, as well as the ones they want to distance themselves from (Han et al., 2010).

Veblen (1965) argued that simply accumulating wealth doesn't automatically confer status — it's visible evidence of that wealth that does. This helps explain conspicuous luxury consumption as a symbol of success. People often define others, and even themselves, through the objects they own, treating possessions as extensions of their own identity. A person might use luxury goods specifically to express who they are, or to signal belonging to a certain group. Material possessions offer people happiness and serve as reminders of experiences, achievements, and relationships — they carry a sense of one's past, showing who someone is, where they've come from, and where they're headed (Belk, 1988).

Not every brand carries the same degree of luxury, and, as already noted, there's no single fixed definition of luxury to begin with. Even the same brand's perceived luxury level can shift depending on the product category or situation — Cartier, for example, may feel more luxurious in jewelry than in apparel or fragrance, and Rolls-Royce is seen as luxury in the automotive world but not in aircraft engines (Vigneron & Johnson, 2004; Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

To help sort luxury brands more systematically, Vigneron and Johnson (2004) built a valuation model — the Brand Luxury Index (BLI) — made up of five perceived dimensions. Three of these are non-personal: perceived conspicuousness, perceived uniqueness, and perceived quality. The other two are personal: perceived hedonism and perceived extended self. According to the authors, all five dimensions need to be tracked and managed for a luxury brand to endure, since a brand has to balance both personal and interpersonal perceptions to succeed financially over the long run (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

These five factors are interconnected and sit underneath how consumers decide whether to buy into a luxury brand. All five matter to consumers generally, though different customers weigh them differently. The BLI scale can also be used to compare brands against each other and spot competitive advantages within a given market (Vigneron & Johnson, 2004).

Berthon et al. (2009) break consumer perceptions of luxury down into three value dimensions instead: functional, experiential, and symbolic. Vickers and Renand (2003) similarly argue that luxury brands differ fundamentally from non-luxury brands along these lines, since consumers simply expect more from luxury. Because these three dimensions are shaped by context, they can shift over time depending on the individual and the surrounding culture, effectively being co-created between the brand and its consumers (Tynan et al., 2010).

The functional dimension covers the material, core benefits of a product — quality, functionality, reliability, durability, craftsmanship — with quality standing out as especially important since it signals how well a product performs.

The experiential dimension reflects individual, subjective value — a person's own taste and where they find hedonic enjoyment in a brand. This can be triggered by design, packaging, communication, and environment, all of which shape a consumer's sensations, feelings, perceptions, and behavior (Berthon et al., 2009). Luxury products, in this sense, deliver consumption experiences that satisfy needs or wants (Holbrook, 1999). Because luxury is seen as rare, precious, and unique, it can also shape thoughts and feelings through a consumer's desire for uniqueness, on top of pure hedonic motives (Hung et al., 2011). In short, the experiential dimension answers what the brand means to the individual.

The symbolic dimension, meanwhile, is about what the brand signals to others — its meaning within the broader social group (Berthon et al., 2009). This nominal value conveys conspicuousness, expense, and wealth (Hung et al., 2011), and matters enormously for premium products since it carries the brand's dream and story. It covers what the brand communicates about the person using it — wealth, prestige, performance, style — to others (other-directed signaling), as well as what that signaling does for the person doing the signaling, extending their sense of self (Belk, 1988). That said, a brand's symbolic value only really works within the community that recognizes it; outside that community, its social meaning fades.

This symbolic dimension matters a great deal for how global luxury brands manage and market themselves, since social influence strongly shapes purchase intent, especially among socially-oriented consumers (Tsai, 2005). Luxury brands need to balance all three dimensions rather than overemphasizing one at the expense of the others — a brand's quality, for instance, shouldn't suffer just because its symbolic appeal gets all the attention. Ideally, luxury brands combine the material (objective, functional), individual (subjective, experiential), and social (collective, symbolic) spheres (Berthon et al., 2009).

Wiedmann et al. (2007) built a conceptual framework showing that financial, functional, individual, and social dimensions all shape how consumers perceive and consume luxury value. These four dimensions are closely related but distinct, and each feeds into a consumer's overall sense of luxury value. Within them sit sub-dimensions: price value under financial value; usability, quality, and uniqueness under functional value; self-identity, hedonic, and materialistic value under individual value; and conspicuousness and prestige value under social value. Even when a brand's overall luxury level is perceived similarly across different customer groups, these underlying dimensions can be weighed quite differently. This model helps explain what drives luxury perception and, by extension, consumer behavior — useful not just for understanding customers but also for creating, marketing, and monitoring luxury

brands.

Wiedmann et al.'s (2007) framework is generally regarded as the most thorough and complete of its kind, though later research has proposed additions. Ciornea et al. (2011), for instance, added investment value to the financial dimension and heritage value to the functional dimension, along with other possible sub-dimensions like superfluousness, which ties closely to materialism. There's also room to look more closely at how the individual and social value dimensions shape both overall perceived luxury value and purchase intent — questions this study explores further in the sections that follow.

Filipino millennials are known for their attachment to gadgets, which drains their finances to some degree, though they also lean on technology to find deals and discounts on airfare, food, travel packages, and more.

Visa's research found that 80% of Filipino millennials still prefer cash over credit cards, largely because they distrust the credit card system over concerns about privacy and confidentiality — suggesting a need for greater financial literacy around credit card use (https://www.ecomparemo.com/info/who-are-the-filipino-millennials-and-what-are-their-spending-habits/).

According to Madelaine B. Miraflor, millennials' purchasing power is rising quickly, showing up in growing retail spending on personal care, home care, and food items. Kantar Worldpanel backs this up, noting that Filipino millennials' capacity to spend on personal and household cleanliness, convenience, and enjoyment keeps climbing (https://business.mb.com.ph/2016/11/19/millennials-purchasing-power-growing-study/).

Background of the Study

Given how little research exists on the attitudes of Filipino millennials toward buying and using luxury brands, this study was built to establish a scientific foundation that future research can build on, contributing to both business and academic understanding.

Within the Philippine context specifically, the variables examined here have barely been studied, since this subject area had not been thoroughly researched at the time this work was conducted.

Significance of the Study

The findings offer a scientific foundation for understanding the brand attitudes of Filipino millennials — a group that makes up about a third of the country's population and roughly half its labor force.

Objectives of the Study

This study looks at how actual and ideal self-congruity shape millennial consumers' attitudes toward luxury brands, along with how materialistic and status-value dimensions factor into those attitudes.

It aims to build a fuller picture of young consumers' brand attitudes and buying behavior toward luxury goods, with the goal of helping brands unlock the commercial potential of this segment and meet the specific needs of Gen-Y consumers among Filipino millennials. Specifically, the study aims to:

1. Determine what motivates Filipino millennials to buy and use luxury brands, in terms of actual and ideal self-congruity.

2. Identify which variables — across education, income, gender, and age groups — significantly affect the purchase and consumption of luxury brands among Filipino millennials.

3. Determine how materialistic value, status value, and social desirability scores affect the purchase and use of luxury brands among Filipino millennials.

Statement of the Problem

This study centers on how actual and ideal self-congruity — that is, how closely a consumer's self-image matches a luxury brand's image — shapes brand attitude. The ideal self-image refers to how a person wants to be, or wishes to be seen, including the attitudes, perceptions, and feelings they hope others will associate with them (Ross, 1971; Schenk & Holman, 1980).

Consuming luxury brands can help someone move closer to their ideal self by projecting the image and symbolic meaning tied to those brands, reinforcing a more perfect self-image.

Because self-concept matters so much to individuals, behavior is often geared toward reinforcing one's own self-concept — consuming luxury goods and brands as symbols that communicate meaning both to oneself and to others (Grubb & Grathwohl, 1967).

Brand attitude plays a central role in a brand's overall equity. It reflects an individual's overall evaluation of a brand, shaped mainly by how they perceive it (Aaker, 1997). Self-congruity, in turn, helps explain and predict both brand attitude and purchase intent (Sirgy et al., 1997; Helgeson & Supphellen, 2004). Self-identity value, materialistic value, and status value are all closely tied together (Richins & Dawson,

1992; Dittmar, 1994; Webster & Beatty, 1997).

1. To what extent are Filipino millennials motivated to purchase and consume luxury brands in terms of actual and ideal self-congruity?

2. What effect do materialistic value and status value have on the purchase and consumption of luxury brands among Filipino millennials?

3. Which variables — across education, income, gender, and age groups — significantly affect the purchase and consumption of luxury brands among Filipino millennials?

4. Which items show significant correlations with the purchase and consumption of luxury brands among Filipino millennials?

Methodology

This study looks at how actual and ideal self-congruity shape attitudes toward luxury brands, using a descriptive research design meant to examine the relationship between variables within the Philippine setting. A survey was the main tool used, with data gathered through a questionnaire and later standardized for easier comparison. Both primary and secondary data were used, with the primary data collected specifically to answer the research questions and meet the study's objectives. The questionnaire relied entirely on closed, pre-set questions rather than open-ended ones — a highly structured format that kept respondents' own wording to a minimum.

To help respondents distinguish luxury from non-luxury, the questionnaire opened by presenting several well-known Philippine brands in both categories, giving respondents a concrete brand to picture before answering the questions that followed. A five-point Likert scale was used throughout, running from strongly disagree to strongly agree. The study also included a shortened version of the Crowne-Marlowe social desirability scale (Crowne & Marlowe, 1960) to gauge how much respondents cared about social approval, since social desirability bias is one of the most common distortions in survey research (King & Bruner, 2000). A lower score on this scale suggests a respondent is less worried about social approval and more likely to answer honestly and represent themselves accurately (Crowne & Marlowe, 1960).

Respondents were Filipino millennials drawn from a higher education institution, along with young entrepreneurs, employees, employers, and graduates who consume luxury brands, since this was the population the study was interested in. The sample totaled 134 respondents — a number considered sufficient to meet the standards of efficiency, representativeness, reliability, and flexibility that Kothari (2004) sets out for an optimal sample.

Non-probability convenience sampling was used, chosen for how easy it made gathering responses; this combined self-selection sampling with convenience sampling. OJT students and alumni helped distribute the questionnaire as enumerators.

Data Analysis

Survey data was processed using SPSS, relying mainly on descriptive statistics to describe and compare variables numerically.

Results

Descriptive statistics were run first to build a picture of the participants. The hypotheses were then tested to check the relationship between actual and ideal self-congruity, materialistic value, and status value, and how these shape brand attitudes toward both luxury and non-luxury brands. In total, 134 respondents took part in the study.

This section covers the demographic makeup of the sample as well as the results of the Marlowe-Crowne social desirability scale.

Frequency Table – Age

Age	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
18-25	38	28.4	28.4	28.4
26-30	51	38.1	38.1	66.4
35 up	45	33.6	33.6	100.0
Total	134	100.0	100.0	

Frequency Table – Gender

Gender	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Male	64	47.8	47.8	47.8
Female	70	52.2	52.2	100.0
Total	134	100.0	100.0	

Frequency Table – Education

Education	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Secondary	19	14.2	14.2	14.2
Bachelor	69	51.5	51.5	65.7
Master	10	7.5	7.5	73.1
PhD	5	3.7	3.7	76.9
Other	31	23.1	23.1	100.0
Total	134	100.0	100.0	

Frequency Table – Income

Income	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
below 15,000	30	22.4	22.4	22.4
15,001 - 30,000	30	22.4	22.4	44.8
30,001 - 50,000	37	27.6	27.6	72.4
50,001 - 75,000	21	15.7	15.7	88.1
75,001 - 100,000	16	11.9	11.9	100.0
Total	134	100.0	100.0	

The sample split fairly evenly by gender, with 47.8% (64) male respondents and 52.2% (70) female respondents.

In terms of education — whether currently enrolled or the highest degree completed — the sample was 51.5% (69) Bachelor's degree holders, 7.5% (10) Master's, 3.7% (5) PhD, 14.2% (19) Secondary level, and 23.1% (31) falling into an "other" category. Ages ranged from 18 to 37, with a median of 25 and a mean of 27.5. The gender split held up well, and the sample included a notably high share of respondents with a master's degree. The age spread was also reasonably good, capturing millennial consumers across different life stages. Income levels weren't unusually high, largely because many respondents were full-time students at the time — so income wasn't factored into the analysis.

The table below shows the Marlowe-Crowne social desirability scale results. More responses landed on the socially desirable side, suggesting the survey results are reasonably reliable, though respondents did show some tendency toward socially desirable answers.

Marlowe-Crowne Social Desirability Scale Results

Question	T	F
a) I have never intensely disliked anyone.	88	46
b) Sometimes feel resentful when I don't get my way.	50	84
c) Always careful about my manner of dress.	114	20
d) If I could get into a movie without paying and be sure I was not seen, I would probably do it.	17	117
e) I don't find it particularly challenging to get along with loudmouthed, obnoxious people.	66	68
f) I sometimes think when people have a misfortune, they only got what they deserved.	32	102
g) I am sometimes irritated by people who ask favors of me.	7	127

Sum of total answers — Socially Undesirable: 240 (25.58%); Socially Desirable: 698 (74.42%).

Descriptive Statistics

	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
ASCL	7	15	11.78	2.179
ASCLN	5	15	12.07	2.511
ISCL	7	15	11.97	2.278
ISCLN	5	15	11.73	2.636

ASCL – Actual Self Congruity on Luxury Brand; ASCLN – Actual Self Congruity on Non-Luxury Brand; ISCL – Ideal Self Congruity on Luxury Brand; ISCLN – Ideal Self Congruity on Non-Luxury Brand.

The ISCL mean (11.97) came in higher than the ASCL mean (11.78), meaning respondents' attitude toward buying and using luxury brands leans more on ideal self-congruity than actual self-congruity. For non-luxury brands, the pattern flips: the ASCLN mean (12.07) outpaced the ISCLN mean (11.73), showing respondents are driven more by actual self-congruity when it comes to non-luxury purchases.

Mean Values for the Variables Across Different Age Groups

AGE	ASCL	MTV	ASCLN	ISCL	ISCLN	SV	SDR
1	12.21	29.11	12.37	12.34	12.11	22.18	11.53
2	11.51	27.61	11.86	11.75	11.41	21.80	11.06

3	11.71	27.87	12.04	11.91	11.78	21.58	11.11
Total	11.78	28.12	12.07	11.97	11.73	21.84	11.21

Across every variable, the 18-25 age bracket posted the highest mean scores, showing they are more motivated than other age groups to buy and use both luxury and non-luxury brands, whether driven by actual or ideal self-congruity. They also placed more weight on materialistic values, social values, and social desirability compared to older respondents.

Mean Values for the Variables Across Different Gender Groups

GENDER	ASCL	MTV	ASCLN	ISCL	ISCLN	SV	SDR
1	11.98	30.53	12.36	12.20	11.92	24.09	12.08
2	11.59	25.91	11.80	11.76	11.56	19.77	10.41
Total	11.78	28.12	12.07	11.97	11.73	21.84	11.21

Male respondents scored higher than female respondents across every variable measured. Men appear more motivated to buy luxury brands based on both actual and ideal self-congruity, and place more value on materialistic factors (functionality), social factors (prestige, image, reputation), and social desirability than women do — though both genders still align in the overall pattern across variables.

Mean Values for the Variables Across Different Education Groups

EDUC	ASCL	MTV	ASCLN	ISCL	ISCLN	SV	SDR
1	11.84	26.11	11.79	11.95	11.47	18.53	10.16
2	11.70	28.64	12.07	11.97	11.62	22.74	11.43
3	12.40	26.60	12.50	12.20	12.10	22.30	11.10
4	11.40	32.40	12.20	11.80	11.80	26.80	12.80
5	11.77	28.00	12.06	11.94	12.00	20.90	11.13
Total	11.78	28.12	12.07	11.97	11.73	21.84	11.21

Respondents with a master's degree posted the highest means for ASCL, ASCLN, ISCL, and ISCLN, while those with a doctorate scored highest on materialistic value, social value, and social desirability. In other words, master's degree holders are more motivated to buy and use luxury brands based on self-congruity, while doctorate holders lean more on materialistic and social value along with social desirability.

Mean Values for the Variables Across Different Income Groups

INCOME	ASCL	MTV	ASCLN	ISCL	ISCLN	SV	SDR
1	11.73	25.20	12.20	12.23	11.90	18.30	10.00
2	12.07	28.77	12.33	12.20	12.07	22.67	11.47
3	12.05	30.73	12.51	12.30	12.11	24.03	12.08
4	11.14	29.19	11.05	11.24	10.90	23.05	11.71
5	11.50	24.94	11.63	11.25	11.00	20.25	10.31
Total	11.78	28.12	12.07	11.97	11.73	21.84	11.21

Respondents earning between 15,000-30,000 and 30,001-50,000 showed the strongest motivation to buy and use both luxury and non-luxury brands, whether based on actual or ideal self-congruity, compared to other income brackets. Materialistic value, social value, and social desirability as motivators peaked instead among the 30,001-50,000 and 50,001-75,000 income brackets. Overall, middle-income Filipino millennials appear more motivated to buy and use luxury brands, with a stronger focus on functionality, image or prestige, and social acceptance in their purchase and consumption decisions.

ANOVA – Age

	Mean Square	F	Sig.
ASCL	5.489	1.159	.317
MTV	26.577	.726	.486
ASCLN	2.802	.441	.645
ISCL	3.999	.768	.466
ISCLN	5.309	.761	.469
SV	3.830	.121	.886
SDR	2.704	.616	.542

None of the variables showed a statistically significant relationship with age.

ANOVA – Gender

	Mean Square	F	Sig.
ASCL	5.313	1.120	.292
MTV	712.666	22.759	.000
ASCLN	10.461	1.668	.199
ISCL	6.650	1.285	.259
ISCLN	4.448	.638	.426
SV	624.608	23.345	.000
SDR	92.554	25.056	.000

Gender showed a significant relationship with materialistic value, social value, and social desirability as motivators for purchase and consumption. Consistent with the mean values above, male respondents were more strongly motivated by materialistic value, social value, and social desirability than female respondents.

ANOVA – Education

	Mean Square	F	Sig.
ASCL	1.282	.264	.900
MTV	52.690	1.466	.216
ASCLN	.857	.132	.970
ISCL	.180	.034	.998
ISCLN	1.422	.200	.938
SV	104.184	3.594	.008

SDR	9.371	2.228	.070

Education showed no significant relationship with most variables, though it came close to significance for social value and social desirability. This suggests that as respondents attain higher levels of education, social value and social desirability start to play more of a role in their purchase and consumption decisions.

ANOVA – Income

	Mean Square	F	Sig.
ASCL	3.772	.790	.534
MTV	176.612	5.504	.000
ASCLN	8.746	1.404	.236
ISCL	6.794	1.322	.265
ISCLN	8.096	1.171	.327
SV	161.124	5.918	.000
SDR	23.051	6.094	.000

Income showed a significant relationship with materialistic value, social value, and social desirability — as income rises, respondents appear more motivated to buy and consume based on functionality, prestige, and social acceptance.

Correlations

S.N.	Variables	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	ASCL						
2	MTV	0.16					
3	ASCLN	.891**	0.12				
4	ISCL	.876**	0.15	.927**			
5	ISCLN	.872**	0.12	.942**	.899**		
6	SV	0.14	.893**	0.11	0.14	0.10	
7	SDR	0.09	.954**	0.06	0.08	0.06	.948**

*** Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).*

ASCL correlates with ASCLN, ISCL, and ISCLN, meaning the motivation to buy and use luxury brands based on actual self-congruity is linked to ideal self-congruity attitudes toward both luxury and non-luxury brands, as well as to actual self-congruity toward non-luxury brands. In short, Filipino millennials' purchase and consumption patterns are interconnected regardless of whether the brand is luxury or non-luxury, or whether the motivation is actual or ideal self-congruity. Materialistic value also correlates strongly with social value and social desirability, indicating that respondents are strongly motivated by functionality, prestige/image/reputation, and social desirability or acceptance in their purchase and consumption choices.

Conclusion

The Filipino millennials' attitude toward buying and using luxury brands leans more heavily on ideal self-congruity than on actual self-congruity. Marketers should keep in mind that Filipino millennials are driven to buy and use luxury brands based on how they want to see themselves, which means they:

– Want to picture themselves as part of the luxury brand's world

– Want the people they admire to also use the luxury brand

– Want to be associated with the kind of people who consume that luxury brand

Recommendation

Since Filipino millennials are motivated to buy and use luxury brands mainly through ideal self-congruity, marketers should consider the following:

1. Luxury brands should feel relatable and consistent with, and should align closely with, the millennial consumer's ideal self.

2. Marketers should choose endorsers, models, and advertising themes or slogans that align with Filipino millennials' ideal self — emphasizing functionality, image or reputation, and social desirability — across promotional strategy, packaging, and distribution channels that come across as upscale and refined.

Because Filipino millennials' attitude toward luxury brand purchase and consumption is driven more by ideal self-congruity than actual self-congruity, marketers should keep this consistently in mind when shaping their strategy, since millennials:

– Want to picture themselves as part of the luxury brand's world

– Want the people they admire to also use the luxury brand

– Want to be associated with the kind of people who consume that luxury brand

One limitation worth noting is the absence of open-ended questions, which could have let respondents explain their views in more depth and offered a fuller picture of what really drives luxury consumption. That said, allowing open responses could also have produced answers only tangentially related to the specific luxury value dimensions under study, given how many other dimensions exist beyond those examined here. Open-ended questions were therefore left out to keep the survey from becoming too long.

Future research could also take a qualitative approach instead, offering broader insight into the phenomenon and letting respondents express their views more freely. This could then be paired with a follow-up survey questionnaire built around whatever themes emerge from the qualitative findings, helping to zero in on the most relevant aspects of the phenomenon and surface new research directions.

Luxury brand consumption remains a large and growing area, and there is plenty of room for further research into it.

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